

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #016 — Phase 2, Film 1: Release Date & Full Film Sheet

CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

HITSVILLE 3

LEAD: Berry Gordy • RELEASE: Friday, May 2, 2014

Phase 2, Film 1 • The Iron Man 3 role • Motown Productions / Paramount • PG-13 • approx. 160 min

A. Release Date: Friday, May 2, 2014

Iron Man 3 opened on Friday, May 3, 2013. Every TMU film opens **exactly 52 weeks after its MCU counterpart**, the rule all of Phase 1 followed. That puts *Hitsville 3* on Friday, May 2, 2014, the first Friday in May, opening Phase 2.

B. The Iron Man 3 Blueprint Map

Iron Man 3	Hitsville 3 (documented history)
Tony, shaken after the Battle of New York	Gordy, shaken after 1967–68: the Detroit riot, Holland–Dozier–Holland walking out, and his family of stars breaking apart
His house and suits destroyed	He leaves the Detroit that built Motown, and Hitsville's era ends with the company's move to Los Angeles (1972)
He rebuilds on his wits alone	He reinvents Motown in Hollywood and makes his first feature film, <i>Lady Sings the Blues</i> (1972)
Pepper Potts proves her own power	Diana Ross leaves the Supremes (Jan. 1970) and earns an Oscar nomination as Billie Holiday
“I am Iron Man”: the man, not the suit	Motown is Gordy, not a building on West Grand Boulevard

C. Full Film Sheet (Memo #008)

1. Title: *Hitsville 3*

It follows the *Iron Man 3* naming pattern. To the public, it's the third film in a hit biopic series (Memo #007).

2. What's Being Adapted

Source	Used for
Primary: Berry Gordy, <i>To Be Loved</i> (1994)	Gordy's point of view, 1968–1973
J. Randy Taraborrelli, <i>Call Her Miss Ross</i> (1989); Mary Wilson, <i>Dreamgirl</i> (1986)	Diana Ross's departure from the Supremes and her move into film
Production history of <i>Lady Sings the Blues</i> , and the Academy Awards record	The making of the film, the fight with the studio, and the five Oscar nominations

3. What the Movie Is About

Logline: With Detroit in flames and his hit-makers gone, Berry Gordy bets everything on one star and one city, Diana Ross and Hollywood, to prove that Motown is more than a house on West Grand Boulevard.

Act One: The Wreckage (1968–1969). The riot has scarred Detroit. Holland–Dozier–Holland have walked out, and the lawsuits start. The old family is scattered. Gordy is running on nerves and spending more and more time in Los Angeles.

Act Two: The Bet (1970–1971). Diana Ross gives her farewell performance with the Supremes at the Frontier Hotel in Las Vegas (January 1970). Gordy develops a Billie Holiday film for her. The studio doubts that a pop star can play Billie Holiday. Gordy puts in his own money and takes control of the production.

Act Three: The Man, Not the House (1972–1973). Motown moves its headquarters to Los Angeles, and the Hitsville era ends. *Lady Sings the Blues* opens (October 1972) and earns five Academy Award nominations, including Best Actress for Diana Ross. Gordy walks into the Oscars (1973) as a Hollywood producer. Motown is wherever he is.

4. Whose Movie / Franchise It Is

Berry Gordy's. This is his third solo film, with him at full strength (No-Nerf): the gambler, the builder and the man who never stops, all as documented.

5. Antagonist

Level	Antagonist	What the record supports
Primary	Hollywood's doubts	A studio system that didn't believe a Motown pop star could carry a serious drama. Gordy beats it with his own money and control. It plays the role of Aldrich Killian: the establishment rival.
Secondary	The Holland–Dozier–Holland lawsuits	A real legal war over money and credit. Both sides had a case, and no one is portrayed as a villain.
Internal	Gordy's fear of losing it all again	The strain after 1967–68, just as Tony carried his after New York.

6. Timeline: When & Where

	Setting
When	1968 to spring 1973. The fixed points are the HDH exit (1968), Ross's farewell (Jan. 1970), the move to Los Angeles (1972), the release of <i>Lady Sings the Blues</i> (Oct. 1972), and the Oscars (1973).
Where	Detroit (Hitsville, after the riot), Las Vegas (the Frontier Hotel), and Los Angeles (Motown's new headquarters, the film set and the Oscars).
Master timeline	TMU Chapter Six. It picks up right after the events of 1967 (shown in full in <i>The Motortown Revue: Dancing in the Street</i>) and carries Motown into its Los Angeles era.

7. Standalone World-Building

Motown's Hollywood world: Los Angeles in the early 1970s, the film business, the making of *Lady Sings the Blues*, and Gordy and Ross as a professional team. The story is complete from wreckage to rebirth.

8. Motown Universe World-Building

Type	Established in Hitsville 3
Returning	Gordy, Diana Ross, Esther, Smokey, Suzanne de Passe (the co-writer of <i>Lady Sings the Blues</i>), and the Hitsville sets, shown one last time.
New setting	Motown's Los Angeles headquarters. It becomes a second hub for later films.
Crossover scene	The 1972 move to Los Angeles, shown from Gordy's side. It's shared with <i>The Tears of a Clown</i> , which shows it from Smokey's side, with matching staging (Memo #005).
Plot elements	Motown Productions is founded on screen. This is the real company behind the TMU (Memo #002).

9. Post-Credits Scene: One

Scene	What happens
End-credits (Los Angeles, 1973)	Gordy tells Smokey the whole story of the last five years, start to finish, and Smokey nods off halfway through. It's a light scene of two old friends, mirroring <i>Iron Man 3</i> 's Tony-and-Bruce ending.

10. How It Kicks Everything Off

N/A. This field is for the first film only (Memo #008).

Compliance Check

Mandate	Status
Fidelity (Memo #001)	PASS. Every event, song, credit and date comes from the documented record.
No-Nerf (Memo #001)	PASS. Every character appears at full documented strength.
Studio (Memos #002–#003)	PASS. Motown Productions, distributed by Paramount.
Phase (Memo #004)	PASS. Phase 2, Film 1 of 6. Released May 2, 2014.
Story model (Memo #005)	PASS. 60% serialized / 40% standalone (Phase 2 target).
Format (Memo #005)	PASS. Musical Biographical Drama, PG-13, approx. 160 min.
Continuity (Memo #005)	PASS. The same actors and sets return, the Los Angeles move matches <i>The Tears of a Clown</i> , and the dates fit the master timeline.
Secrecy (Memo #007)	PASS. Publicly marketed as the third Gordy biopic, with no universe branding.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios. The people named are real. The films and the roles here are fictional.